



CHALLENGE 02 · CHIANG MAI'S CULTURAL LAYERS

อู๋เมือง

Uu Muang

Translation is transactional.
Uu Muang is contextual.

Presented by [Team name]

Claude Impact Labs Chiang Mai · 27 Sep 2026

Built with Claude

THE PROBLEM

One stall, two people, no shared words

THE MOMENT

A cook wanted to show us a dish that wasn't on the menu. She explained the vegetable in Thai; Google Translate said “fern vegetable”.

She was proud of it. We never found out what it was.

The visitor

Can't ask what's in a dish, or read the Northern words on the sign

Buys the safe option: the same three or four dishes on repeat

The vendor

Can't explain her food, its season or how spicy it is

Loses the sale, and the chance to share what she's proud of

WHY EXISTING AI TRANSLATION FALLS SHORT

Generic translators miss the Lanna layer



Kham Mueang dialect

Northern words, and six tones instead of five, that standard Thai tools don't know



Local food and ingredients

Phak kut, cha-om, tua nao: market vegetables and condiments with no English name



Everyday customs

A nod can mean “I heard you”, not yes. How to greet, bargain and thank the Lanna way

Example ยินดีเจ้า → generic translator: “glad” → **Uu Muang**: “thank you” in Kham Mueang

WHO WE SERVE

Built for both sides of the stall

[Photo]

THE VENDOR

[Name], [age]

[Stall], e.g. vegetables at Kad Luang

NEEDS

To explain her food and ingredients to visitors

FRUSTRATION TODAY

Visitors point, shrug and walk away

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

A visitor buys, comes back and asks for more

[Photo]

THE VISITOR

[Name], [age]

Digital nomad, [X] months in Chiang Mai

NEEDS

To understand what's in front of them, and ask about it

FRUSTRATION TODAY

Translation apps return nonsense for Northern food

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

A new favourite dish, and a vendor who knows their name

OUR SOLUTION

Uu Muang turns every stall into a conversation

[App screenshot]

Levelled-up translation that uses your real-time data: where you are, what's in season, and who you're talking to.

1

Read and hear it

Thai, Kham Mueang and English: speech and signs at the stall

2

Understand it

What a vegetable is, why it's in season, what each condiment does at a khao soi shop

3

Start talking

Icebreakers and phrases vendors love to hear, with pronunciation

CUSTOMISABLE CONTEXT

You choose the layers the other person sees

☐ About me: where I'm from, what I love to eat

☐ Where we are: this market and its specialities

☐ In season now: produce, dishes, festivals

☐ Food and culture notes

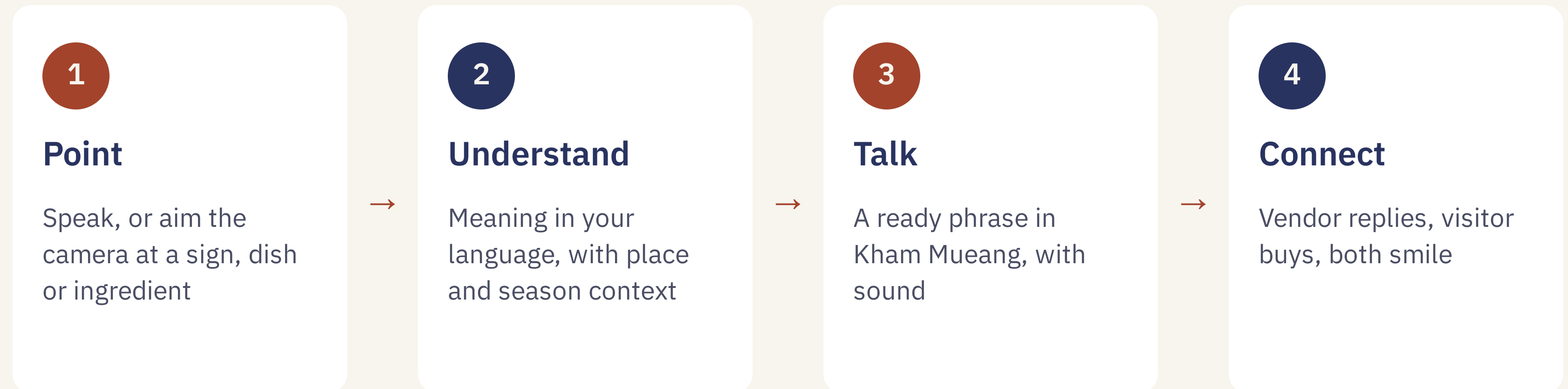
☐ Etiquette tips, like hearing a polite no

Conversations become discoveries.

Each layer adds depth and clarity. New foods, cultures and relationships, and both people understand each other better.

HOW IT WORKS

From pointing to talking in [X] seconds



Built with: Claude (Claude API), web app, browser speech-to-text and text-to-speech, open Lanna data

Works for: any phone browser, no install · QR code at the stall

LIVE DEMO

See it at the stall

1 The scene

Warorot Market (Kad Luang). A visitor points at a curly green vegetable; the vendor speaks Kham Mueang.

2 Uu Muang in action

The visitor asks by voice. The vendor sees the question in Thai plus a card about who's asking, and answers.

3 The result

It's phak kut, a wild fern in season now, stir-fried or in kaeng khae. The visitor buys, and says “lam khanat!”

[QR code]

[App URL]

Scan and try it

DAY-ONE IMPACT · COUNTS DOUBLE

What changes the first day someone uses it

[X]

vendors tested it

[X]

visitors tested it

[X]%

understood the dish or the reply

For vendors, on day one

- Explain their food without English
- Win a sale they would have lost

For visitors, on day one

- Order with confidence, beyond the usual three dishes
- A first real conversation with a local

“[Real quote from a vendor or visitor who tried it]” · [Name, stall or country]

DISTINCTLY LANNA

Built on Northern knowledge, not generic translation

1,502

Lanna dictionary words

6

Northern Thai tones mapped

59

Northern recipes, with Kham Mueang pronunciation

7

provinces researched from Thai sources

23

Chiang Mai markets mapped

650+

sources, 312 of them in Thai



อูเมือง
Uu Muang



Mor Hom
Indigo

#293360



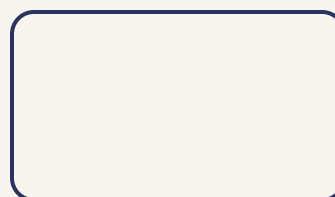
Clay Red

#A3432C



Ping River
Cyan

#2D80A3



Sa Paper

#F7F5EE

OUR MARK

A market basket that talks

The basket

The กระจ, the woven bamboo basket at every Lanna market stall, shaped into a speech bubble. Language tied to everyday commerce and community.

The weave

Shared conversation builds connection.

The open tail

Local knowledge opens to visitors beyond the market walls.

The colours

Natural Lanna tones, not gold: Mor Hom indigo from artisans' blue-dyed cotton, clay red from Lanna earth, on Sa paper.

WHAT'S NEXT

From one market to the whole North

NOW

Warorot Market (Kad Luang):
contextual conversations,
Lanna dictionary, seasonal
data, web app

NEXT 3 MONTHS

More markets, vendor QR
stall cards with daily
specials, photo “what is
this?”, more dishes and
phrases

LATER

Other Lanna provinces,
festivals and events,
partners; a native app with
on-device speech

Open source: github.com/Schummers/chiang-mai-hackathon

THE TEAM

Who built Uu Muang

[Photo]

Jonathan
[Role]

[Photo]

Max
[Role]

[Photo]

Benji
[Role]

[Photo]

Sunny
[Role]

[Photo]

Luke
[Role]

อู้เมืองได้ก้อ?

ได้แล้วเจ้า

Can you speak the local tongue? Now you can.

Thank you · ขอบคุณเจ้า

github.com/Schummers/chiang-mai-hackathon · [\[Contact\]](#)

Built with Claude

